

OVER 200 DEAD IN INDIA PLANE CRASH

AIR INDIA FLIGHT TO LONDON
WAS CARRYING 242 PEOPLE

PLANE CRASHED INTO A
DOCTORS' HOSTEL ON TAKEOFF

FORMER GUJARAT CM AMONG
THOSE KILLED IN CRASH

AHMEDABAD

Police in the Indian city of Ahmedabad said they had collected 204 dead bodies after a London-bound passenger plane with 242 people on board crashed into a doctors' hostel near the Ahmedabad Airport shortly after it took off yesterday.

Air India said there were 169 Indian passengers, 53 British, seven Portuguese, and a Canadian on board the flight bound for London's Gatwick airport.

"We have found 204 bodies," city police commissioner GS Malik told AFP, adding that 41 injured people were "under treatment". The dead included those from the plane crash and from buildings into which the plane smashed. "Rescue work is ongoing," he said.

India's Federation of All India Medical Association (FAIMA) said that around 50 to 60 medical students were taken to hospital after the flight crashed into the hostel. According to the association, five students remain unaccounted for, while at least two are in the ICU. Relatives of some doctors are also reported missing.

FAIMA added that most of the passengers from the ill-fated flight were brought to the hospital deceased.

Senior BJP leader and former Gujarat Chief Minister Vijay Rupani was among those killed in the tragic crash. He was 68.

UAE offers condolences

The UAE has expressed its solidarity and sincere condolences to India.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) expressed its sincere condolences and sympathy to the families



Search and rescue teams respond to the scene of the London-bound Air India plane crash in Ahmedabad, India, yesterday.

of the victims, as well as to the government and people of India, over this tragedy.

Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi said the crash is "heartbreaking beyond words". In a social media post, Modi said the tragedy in Ahmedabad "has stunned and saddened us." "In this sad hour, my thoughts are with everyone affected by it," he said, adding he has been in touch with ministers and authorities who

are working to assist those affected.

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer also expressed deep concern over the crash.

No cause has been confirmed yet, but the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) officials are collecting flight data, voice recordings, and witness statements. Boeing representatives are also expected to assist in the probe.

— Agencies
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MIRACLE SURVIVOR

Ramesh Vishwaskumar Bucharvada, 38, has miraculously survived the deadly crash of Air India flight AI171 yesterday. Seated in 11A, Ramesh reportedly jumped from the aircraft during the crash sequence, with a video showing him walking near the wreckage.

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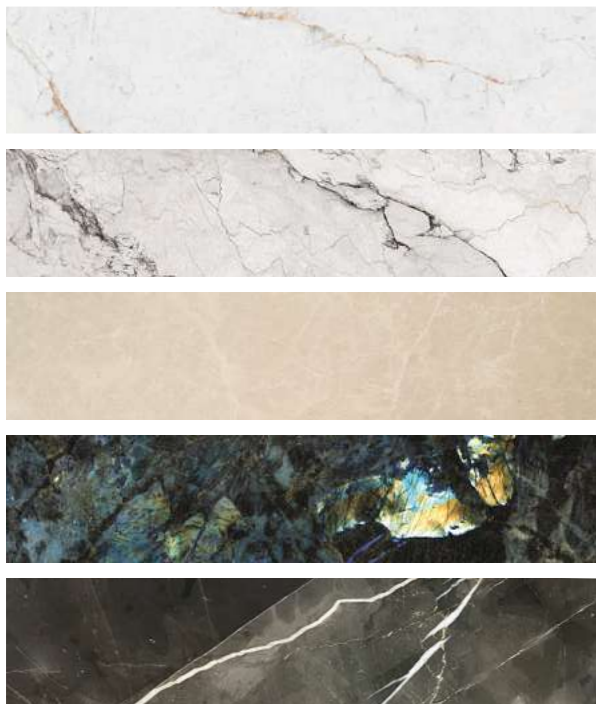
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